



RESULTS OF FURTHER BAT SURVEY WORK

on

**AN AGRICULTURAL BUILDING AT GWARNICK MILL FARM,
ST ALLEN, TRURO, CORNWALL**

May - June 2026



Wheal Grey Ecology Ltd

Henskol Sul, Carwinion Rd, Mawnan Smith,
Falmouth, Cornwall

Email: s.barnard@whealgreynecology.co.uk

Web: www.whealgreynecology.co.uk

Tel: 01326 761092

**RESULTS OF FURTHER BAT SURVEY WORK ON AN
AGRICULTURAL BUILDING AT GWARNICK MILL FARM,
ST ALLEN, TRURO, CORNWALL**

O.S. Grid Ref: SW 81694 49322

Survey date: Emergence surveys - 11th May and 10th June 2026,
Remote detector survey - 11th to 19th June 2026

Lead Surveyor: Simon Barnard BSc (Hons) MSc CEcol MCIEEM
Bat Licence Reg. No. 2025-85771-CL19/20-BAT
Barn Owl Licence Reg. No. 2026-87482-CL29-OWL

Time spent on site: 2 x (2 x 2 hours) – Pair of emergence surveys
2 x ½ hour – Remote detector deployment and collection

Taxonomic groups: Bats

Report author: Simon Barnard BSc (Hons) MSc CEcol MCIEEM

Filename & issue no: FB_Barn at Gwarnick Mill Farm, St Allen_Final 1

Report for: Mr & Mrs Burley

Report No: 25-355_CPG_Barn at Gwarnick Mill Farm, St Allen_FB

Report completed: 3rd July 2026

Report Sign off**Document checked and
approved for issue by:**

Debra Barnard MBBCh Director

Signature:**Date:**8th July 2026

Bat survey work to support planning applications and Bat Mitigation Licences needs to have been completed within 12 months of the applications being made. If the survey work is older than this it is likely that this would need to be updated.

1. SUMMARY

Wheal Grey Ecology Ltd was instructed by Mr Adam Toy, of Cornwall Planning Group on behalf of the clients, Mr & Mrs Burley, to carry out further bat survey work on an agricultural building at Gwarnick Mill Farm, St Allen, Truro, Cornwall to update previous survey findings. The building obtained planning permission for conversion into a dwelling under a Class Q permitted development application in November 2024 with the current proposal being to seek planning permission to demolish the existing building and build a new dwelling in its place.

The further survey work was to take the form of a pair of emergence surveys, using two surveyors paired with four infrared cameras and the deployment of a remote detector within the building for at least 7 consecutive nights.

The results of the further survey work showed that the interior of the building is used for roosting by a maternity colony of Lesser Horseshoes bats (by at least 19 individuals), by at least a single day roosting Common Pipistrelle and occasional night roosting by a single Greater Horseshoes bat. Previous survey work by a third party showed the interior of the building used as an occasional day roost for Greater Horseshoes and a Brown Long-eared night roost. The proposal is to seek planning permission to demolish the existing building and build a new dwelling in its place.

The proposal, in the absence of mitigation would result in destruction of all the existing roosting sites and in the disturbance or harm of any bats present when the building is demolished. With appropriate mitigation, it should be possible to recreate the existing roosting sites onsite, protecting the conservation status of bats in the local area.

As the works will result in the existing roosting sites being destroyed, with any bats present being disturbed or harmed when the building is demolished, a Bat Mitigation Licence from Natural England will need to be obtained, prior to the works commencing. Due to the presence of a maternity colony, a full Bat Mitigation Licence will need to be obtained. The licence application can only be submitted once planning has been granted and the works cannot commence lawfully until the licence is in place.

As all the existing roosting sites will be destroyed when the building is demolished, replacement roosting sites will need to be created. This will need to include replacement cavity roosting sites for Common Pipistrelles and either a built-in bat loft or standalone bat house suitable for use by a Lesser Horseshoe maternity colony, see below for full details. Immediately before any works commence on site, the building will need to be carefully inspected for the presence of roosting bats by the Ecologist named on the Licence or an accredited agent. When the roof coverings are stripped and any other features with the potential to be used by roosting bats are impacted, this will need to be done carefully under the direct supervision of the named ecologist to ensure no bats are harmed and allow any bats found to be relocated out of harm's way. As the building is used by breeding bats but is unlikely to be used by hibernating bats the works should avoid commencing during the Summer maternity period May to September.

Bat survey work to support planning applications and Bat Mitigation Licences needs to have been completed within 12 months of the applications being made. If the survey work is older than this it is likely that this would need to be updated.

2. INTRODUCTION AND BACKGROUND

Wheal Grey Ecology Ltd was instructed by Mr Adam Toy, of Cornwall Planning Group on behalf of the clients, Mr & Mrs Burley, to carry out further bat survey work on an agricultural building at Gwarnick Mill Farm, St Allen, Truro, Cornwall to update previous survey findings. The building obtained planning permission for conversion into a dwelling under a Class Q permitted development application in November 2024 with the current proposal being to seek planning permission to demolish the existing building and build a new dwelling in its place.

A Preliminary Roost Assessment (PRA) was undertaken by Spalding Associates (Environmental) Ltd on 11th June 2024 to assess the building for evidence of bat activity. The PRA was followed by three emergence surveys and the deployment of a remote detector survey, which identified the use of the building by small numbers of day roosting Common Pipistrelle (max count of 3 individuals), for occasional night roosting by Brown Long-eared bats, by Greater Horseshoe bats as an occasional/transitional and by a small maternity roost of Lesser Horseshoe bats (max count of 17 individuals).

The updated further survey work was to take the form of a pair of emergence surveys, using two surveyors paired with four infrared cameras and the deployment of a remote detector within the building for at least 7 consecutive nights. The further survey work can only be undertaken during the active bat survey season, May to September, with at least one of the surveys being undertaken during the peak survey period before the end of August. The surveys should be undertaken at least 4 weeks apart.

2.1. Description of Building

The building subject to this survey is a large roughly rectangular modern agricultural barn which is in several parts. It has a single storey structure running roughly east west along its northern side, which is built from blockwork and has a pitched roof covered with corrugated cement fibre sheeting. It has a small lean-to attach to the western end of the northern side of this part of the barn which has a mono-pitched corrugated cement fibre sheeting covered roof, see Photos 1 and 2.



Photo 1. Showing the northern part of the barn from the north west



Photo 2. Showing the southern and eastern part of the barn from the east

To the south of this is a large two storey structure; the western 3rd of which has blockwork walls enclosing it and separating it from the remainder of the building to the east which is open to the outside along its eastern end with its southern wall being enclosed by metal sheeting, see Photos 3 and 4. Attached to the southern side of the blockwork section of this building is a lean-to extension which is built from blockwork and has a mono-pitched corrugated cement fibre sheeting covered roof, see Photos 5 and 6.



Photo 3. Showing the western end of the larger structure



Photo 4. Showing the larger structure from the east



Photos 5 and 6. Showing southern lean-to from the west (left) and east (right)

Internally the northern structure is divided into three rooms by partition walls, all of which are open to one another and outside via a large opening in the eastern end of the building. There is a large room in the centre with smaller rooms to the east and west. Within the western room there is also a partition wall splitting this space again, east west, creating a small, enclosed room at ground floor level with a ceiling over the southern space creating an enclosed roof space, see Photos 7 to 10. There is a missing block in the partition wall giving direct fly-in access into the roof void, see Photo 11. The central and southern rooms are light internally with windows along its side walls. These rooms are all open from the concrete floor to the underside of the roof which is unlined and to the inside of the walls. The ridge tunnel and wall tops are all open to the interior of the building.



Photo 7. Showing the eastern room in the northern structure



Photo 8. Showing the central room in the northern structure



Photos 9 and 10. Showing the western rooms in the northern structure



Photo 11. Showing the opening into the roof void

The western end of the double pitched roof section of the building is a single large open room which is open from the concrete floor to the underside of the roof, which is unlined, and to the inside of the rendered walls, see Photos 12 and 13.



Photos 12 and 13. Showing the interior of western end two storey section of the building

The two lean-tos are both single rooms, accessed from outside, which are open from the concrete floor to the underside of the roof which are unlined, see Photos 14 and 15.



Photo 14. Showing the western lean-to



Photo 15. Showing the eastern lean-to

2.3. Surrounding landscape

The building subject to this survey is located just over 3km to the north of the City of Truro to the west of Idless Woods in the open countryside in mid Cornwall. There are a small number of other buildings nearby, both dwellings, converted barns and unconverted barns. It is located on the edge of a shallow valley with a small river running past the site to the south. It is surrounded by fields laid to pasture or used for crop production, with an area of solar panels to the west, bound by vegetated Cornish Hedges. Idless Woods, which is an extensive area of woodland extends away to the south east, see Figure 1.



Figure 1. Google Earth image showing the location of the property (red arrow) and surrounding landscape

The habitats surrounding the property represents good bat foraging habitat which is well linked into the surrounding landscape. The surrounding area is known to be used by a range of species of bat, including Common Pipistrelles, Brown Long-eared bats, Whiskered bats, Natterers, Noctules and Lesser and Greater Horseshoes with roosts belonging to a number of these species known to occur nearby.

3. METHODS

3.1. Emergence Surveys

Emergence surveys aim to establish if the building being surveyed is used for day roosting by bats, and if so, to establish the levels of use, confirm the species present, identify the number of individuals present and identify the access points.

An emergence survey involves positioning surveyors, experienced with the use of bat detectors and undertaking emergence surveys, around the outside of the building identified as having the potential to support roosting bats. These surveyors watch the roof line, openings and other features identified as having the potential to support roosting bats or which would allow access into the building from a quarter of an hour before sunset until at least an hour and a half afterwards for emerging bats. The emergence times, locations any bats are seen to emerge from, and the time are recorded along with the time the first bat was heard or seen. Any interesting behaviour observed from bats either relating to the building or passing within the range detectable by the surveyors is also noted down along with the weather conditions and any other relevant information.

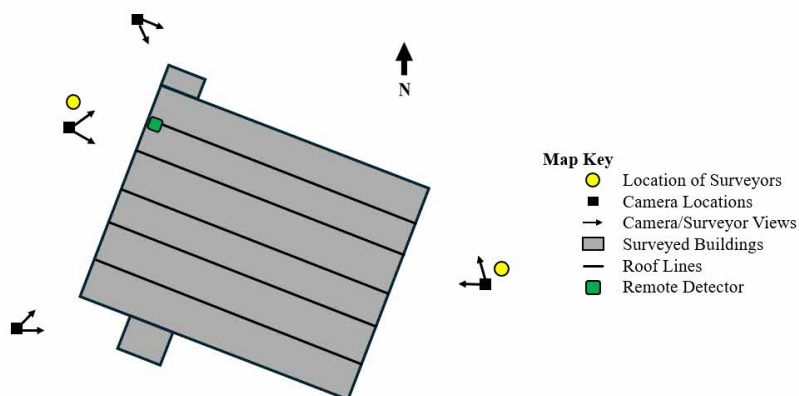


Figure 2. The locations of surveyor/camera set-ups during the emergence surveys

In this instance, a pair of emergence surveys were carried out on the building. The surveys were undertaken by two trained and experienced bat surveyors, supported by four Canon XA cameras, each paired with three Nightfox XC5 infrared torches, with additional illumination provided by three Nightfox ARC infrared floodlights. The cameras recorded for the entire survey and the footage was reviewed in full as soon as possible after the completion of the survey using a laptop and monitor, screen shots of the start and finish views of the infra-red camera setups for the emergence survey are included in this report in Appendix 1.

3.1.1. 1st Emergence Survey, 11th May 2026

On 11th May 2026, Matthew Thurlow and Finn Mawer conducted the first emergence survey. The surveyors were positioned on opposite sides of the building ensuring, with the aid of the cameras, that all elevations of the building were being adequately covered. The survey was carried out during suitable weather conditions for bat activity being cloudy with 60% cloud cover, dry and still. The starting temperature was 11°C and did not change by the end of the survey. The survey started at 20:39 and finished at 22:24, with sunset being at 20:54.

Bat activity was monitored and recorded using two Elekon Batlogger M2's. The surveyors were equipped with four Canon XA Professional camcorders each paired with three Nightfox XC5 infrared torches which were positioned alongside them, as well as a pair of Nightfox whisker night vision binoculars. Additionally, three Nightfox ARC floodlights were used to provide additional illumination to the building.

3.1.2. 2nd Emergence Survey, 10th June 2026

On 10th June 2026, Simon Barnard and Noah Blackwell conducted the second emergence survey. The surveyors were positioned on opposite sides of the building ensuring, with the aid of the cameras, that all elevations of the building were being adequately covered. The survey was carried out during suitable weather conditions for bat activity being clear with 30% light cloud cover, dry and with a light wind. The starting temperature was 13°C which dropped to 12°C by the end of the survey. The survey started at 21:14 and finished at 22:59, with sunset being at 21:29.

Bat activity was monitored and recorded using two Elekon Batlogger M2's. The surveyors were equipped with four Canon XA Professional camcorders, each paired with three Nightfox XC5 infrared torches which were positioned alongside them with three Nightfox ARC floodlights providing additional illumination to the building.

3.2. Remote detector survey

A remote detector survey involves the deployment of a remote or static detector into the building subject to the survey for a set number of nights. As the detector can record throughout the night, and if required throughout the day, they can be used to gain further information on the use of the building by bats, in particular by species which may only visit the building during the night (for night roosting or as a feeding perch). They can also reveal the presence of very late emerging species of bat which could be missed otherwise. The detector is triggered by ultrasonic bat calls, which it records and time stamps, allowing the species, regularity of use of the structure at night, and time of the call to be logged.

The further survey work included the deployment of an Anabat Express remote detector in the western room of the northern structure, between the 10th and 19th June, see Figure 2 for the location of the remote detector. The weather conditions during this period were mostly clear, dry and still with night time temperatures between 11°C and 16 °C. The data was analysed manually by Finn Mawer.

3.3. Surveyors

3.3.1. Simon Barnard

Simon Barnard is an experienced bat surveyor with over 19 years' experience of carrying out all aspects of professional bat survey work including activity surveys, call analysis and emergence surveys. He has held a Natural England survey licence for more than 16 years, currently being registered on the Level 3 (CL19) and level 4 (CL20) Class Survey Licence. He has been involved in designing numerous mitigation schemes and obtaining European Protected Species development licences for the majority of the species of bats found in Devon and Cornwall and is a registered consultant on Annex's B, C and D on the Natural England's Bat Mitigation Class Licence. He also holds a valid Barn Owl Class Survey Licence.

3.3.2. Matthew Thurlow

Matthew Thurlow is an experienced field surveyor with over 6 years' experience working in Ecology and Conservation and carrying out all aspects of professional bat survey work, including activity surveys, call analysis, and emergence surveys. He holds a Bachelor's Degree in Applied Marine Science and a Masters in Conservation and Biodiversity, and is registered on the Level 2 (CL18) Bat Class Survey Licence registered under 2025-84531-CL18-BAT.

3.3.3. Finn Mawer

Finn Mawer is an experienced bat surveyor, trained in the use of bat detectors and carrying out professional bat survey work, including emergence surveys and sound analysis. He has a Bachelor's degree in ecology related subjects and has completed a Master's degree in Ecological Restoration.

3.3.4. Noah Blackwell

Noah Blackwell is a trained surveyor, with knowledge and experience of a number of Phase 2 protected species surveying techniques and species ID.

4. RESULTS

4.1. Emergence Surveys

4.1.1. 1st Emergence survey – 11th May 2026

The first activity of the night, recorded at 21:07, was from a Lesser Horseshoe seen light testing out of the open doorway of the eastern gable end of the northern blockwork section of the building, before flying immediately south and re-entering the building via the northmost open eastern gable end of the metal clad double-pitched barn extent of the building. Then at 21:08, a Lesser Horseshoe was seen exhibiting the same behaviour, access points and flight path, again re-entering the building.

At 21:19, a single Lesser Horseshoe was seen to emerge from the southernmost open doorway on the western elevation before flying west. Then between 21:20 and 21:22, a further five Lesser Horseshoe were seen to emerge from the same location, all flying along the same trajectory, heading immediately west.

Concurrently, at 21:22, another Lesser Horseshoe was seen to emerge on the western elevation of the building from the continuous horizontal gap at the abutment of the northern slope of the central pitched corrugated metal roof with the roof of the northern blockwork section of the building.

At 21:23, a further two Lesser Horseshoe were seen to emerge from the southernmost open doorway on the western elevation before flying west.

At 21:25, a single Lesser Horseshoe was then seen to emerge from the open doorway of the eastern gable end of the northern blockwork section of the building, before flying north, and at 21:32, a further Lesser Horseshoe was seen to emerge from this same location before flying northeast.

Then at 21:38, a single Lesser Horseshoe was seen to emerge from the eastern elevation via the northmost open eastern gable end of the metal clad double-pitched barn extent of the building before flying northwest.

At 21:41, a single Lesser Horseshoe was seen to emerge from the eastmost open window on the northern elevation of the building, then was seen immediately re-entering the building via the same access point, and at 21:43, the bat was seen to exit via the window again before flying northwest.

Finally, at 21:53, a single Greater Horseshoe was seen to enter the building from the west exiting the building to the west and flying north.

Additional activity including feeding and commuting from Common Pipistrelles, Noctules, Lesser & Greater Horseshoe Bats was observed. However, no further activity witnessed during the survey was indicative of emergence from the surveyed building.

In total, 13 Lesser Horseshoe bats were seen to emerge from the building during the first emergence survey.

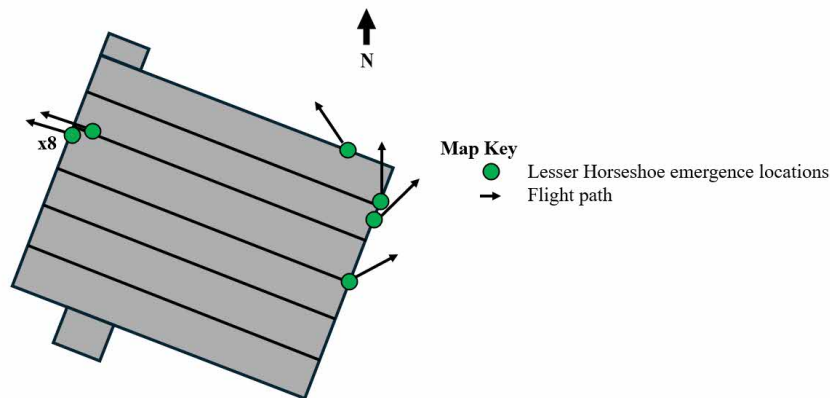


Figure 3. The location from which bats were seen to emerge from the building during the first emergence survey.

4.1.2. 2nd Emergence survey – 10th June 2026

The first activity of the night recorded at 21:46, from a single Lesser Horseshoe seen to emerge from the southernmost open doorway on the western elevation, before flying west.

At 21:48, a single Common Pipistrelle was seen to emerge from a small gap below the corrugated metal sheeting on the southern verge close to the apex of the western gable end of the blockwork extent of the building, before flying west.

At 21:47, two Lesser Horseshoe were seen light-testing within the small room located behind the southernmost open doorway on the western elevation.

At 21:48, a single Lesser Horseshoe was seen to emerge on the western elevation of the building from the continuous horizontal gap at the abutment of the northern slope of the central pitched corrugated metal roof with the roof of the northern blockwork section of the building.

Between 21:51 and 21:53, six Lesser Horseshoe were seen to emerge from the southernmost open doorway on the western elevation, flying in north westerly and westerly directions.

At 21:54, four Lesser Horseshoe were seen to emerge from the southernmost open doorway on the western elevation, flying west. Concurrently, a single Lesser Horseshoe was seen to emerge from the northernmost open doorway on the western elevation, before flying west.

Finally, between 21:55 and 22:01 six further Lesser Horseshoe were seen to emerge from the southernmost open doorway on the western elevation, flying in north westerly to westerly directions.

Overall, 19 Lesser Horseshoe and a single Common Pipistrelle were seen to emerge from the building during the second emergence survey.

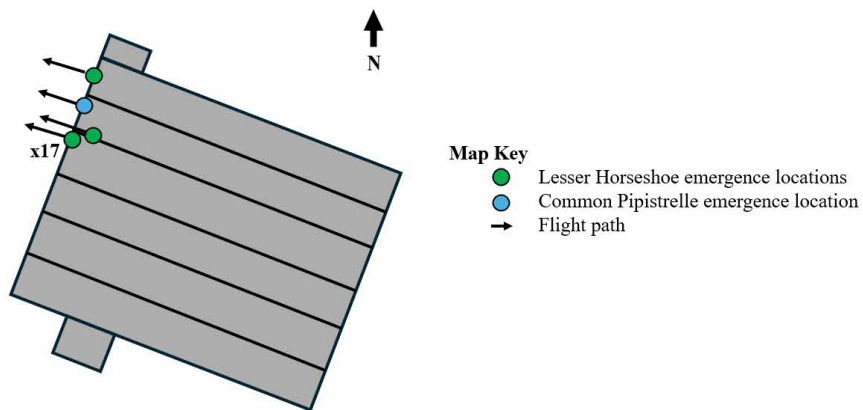


Figure 4. The location from which bats were seen to emerge from the building during the second emergence survey.

4.2. Remote detector survey

The Anabat Express remote detector was deployed in the western room of the northern structure on the evening of 10th June 2026 before being collected on 19th June 2026, and was fully operational throughout the deployment. Seven consecutive nights were fully analysed, from 1st to 17th of June 2026.

During this time, a total of 2854 calls were recorded from six species of bat including Lesser Horseshoe, Common Pipistrelle, Greater Horseshoe, Natterer's, Brown Long-eared bats and Whiskered bats, with bat activity detected on each of the seven nights, see Table 1 below.

Table. 1. Summary of the calls recorded during the remote detector survey

Date	Species	No. of calls	Time of first call	Time of last call	Sunset	Sunrise
11/06/2026	Lesser Horseshoe	217	21:34	04:47	21:29	05:07
	Common Pipistrelle	663	22:11	04:39	21:29	05:07
	Whiskered	1	00:00	00:00	21:29	05:07
	Greater Horseshoe	2	03:59	04:06	21:29	05:07
12/06/2026	Lesser Horseshoe	165	21:08	04:42	21:30	05:07
	Common Pipistrelle	341	22:09	04:23	21:30	05:07
	Natterer's	6	23:14	23:58	21:30	05:07
13/06/2026	Lesser Horseshoe	141	21:35	04:39	21:31	05:07
	Greater Horseshoe	1	22:28	22:28	21:31	05:07
	Common Pipistrelle	5	22:56	00:17	21:31	05:07
	Natterer's	13	23:22	02:03	21:31	05:07
14/06/2026	Lesser Horseshoe	174	21:23	04:40	21:31	05:07
	Common Pipistrelle	11	22:19	02:32	21:31	05:07
	Greater Horseshoe	195	22:37	03:11	21:31	05:07
	Natterer's	3	23:33	23:34	21:31	05:07
15/06/2026	Lesser Horseshoe	278	21:24	04:43	21:32	05:07
	Common Pipistrelle	126	22:26	04:14	21:32	05:07
	Natterer's	12	23:03	01:54	21:32	05:07
	Greater Horseshoe	2	03:27	03:27	21:32	05:07

16/06/2026	Lesser Horseshoe	285	21:19	04:50	21:32	05:07
	Common Pipistrelle	13	22:13	04:54	21:32	05:07
	Greater Horseshoe	33	00:45	03:16	21:32	05:07
17/06/2026	Lesser Horseshoe	132	21:04	04:46	21:32	05:07
	Common Pipistrelle	21	23:06	04:46	21:32	05:07
	Natterer's	4	23:44	01:16	21:32	05:07
	Brown Long-eared	4	01:46	01:48	21:32	05:07
	Greater Horseshoe	6	01:51	02:22	21:32	05:07

Species	No. of calls	Nights Present	Proportion of Calls
Lesser Horseshoe	1392	7	48.77%
Common Pipistrelle	1180	7	41.35%
Natterer's	38	5	1.33%
Brown Long-eared	4	1	0.1%
Greater Horseshoe	239	6	8.37%
Whiskered	1	1	0.04%
	Total Calls	2854	

The majority of the calls were from Lesser Horseshoe bats, with 1392 calls (48.77% of the total), with calls from this species being recorded on all seven nights. These calls were from throughout the nights, starting close to emergence time and finishing close to re-entry time indicating day and night roosting.

1180 calls from Common Pipistrelle were recorded (41.35% of the total), with calls from this species also being recorded on all seven nights. These calls were distributed throughout the

nights, however, were not recorded close to sunset, suggesting Common Pipistrelle do not regularly roost in features in close proximity to the remote detector as day roosts over the survey period. The activity detected is indicative of frequent foraging around the building.

239 calls from Greater Horseshoe were recorded (8.37% of the total), with calls from this species being recorded on six nights, with some night with very small numbers of call and others with higher numbers to 200. These timings of these calls did not show consistency throughout the survey period. The distribution of the calls suggests the building is primarily used by Greater Horseshoe for foraging or occasional night roosting, with no signs of day roosting. Higher numbers of calls were detected on 14th and 16th June suggests night roosting behaviour on these nights.

A total of 43 calls were recorded from Natterer's (38 calls), Brown Long-eared (four calls) and Whiskered (one call) bats, indicative of occasional foraging behaviour in the building.

4.3. Summary of survey results

The results of the further survey work showed that the interior of the building used for roosting by a maternity colony of Lesser Horseshoes bats (by at least 19 individuals), by at least a single day roosting Common Pipistrelle and occasional night roosting by a single Greater Horseshoes bat.

4.4. Status of the roost

4.4.1. Status at local, county and regional levels

Species	UK Conservati on Status (Wray <i>et al.</i> 2010)	UK distribution, population estimate and trends (Matthews <i>et al</i> 2018)	County occurrence	Local occurrence
Lesser Horseshoe <i>Rhinolophus</i> <i>Hipposideros</i>	Rarer	Confined to the Southwest of England and Wales, 50,400 in the UK. Positive trend in roost and hibernation counts, this trend has stabilised over the past five years. NBMP 2018.	Widespread and fairly common.	Widespread and fairly common
Common Pipistrelle <i>Pipistrellus</i> <i>pipistrellus</i>	Common	Found throughout the UK Approx 3,040,000 in UK Populations believed to be increasing.	Common and widespread	Common and widespread

Greater Horseshoe <i>Rhinolophus ferrumequinum</i>	Rarest	Mainly confined to southwest England and Wales Est. 13,200 individuals in Britain. Colony Counts have shown a significant increase in number of individuals over recent years.	Scattered colonies often in less exposed areas throughout Cornwall, only 4 known breeding colonies (2 are designated as SSSI). Population apparently stable	Greater Horseshoes are frequently found throughout this part of Cornwall
Brown Long-eared bat <i>Plecotus auritus</i>	Common	Found throughout the UK 934,000 in UK. No significant trend, population considered to be stable.	Common and widespread except in the most exposed areas	Likely to be common in locality

4.4.2. Status at site level

Lesser Horseshoe

During the first emergence survey, 13 Lesser Horseshoes were seen to emerge from the building with 19 Lesser Horseshoe being seen to emerge from the building during the second emergence survey.

This indicates that building is used by a small maternity colony of Lesser Horseshoes.

Estimated population in any given year: At least 19 Lesser Horseshoes

Common Pipistrelle

During the second emergence survey, a single Common Pipistrelles was seen to emerge from the building. During the previous surveys up to three Common Pipistrelles were seen to emerge from external features on the building.

This indicates that external features are used by small numbers of Common Pipistrelles for day roosting.

Estimated population in any given year: up to three Common Pipistrelles

Greater Horseshoe

A single Greater Horseshoe was seen to fly through the building during the first emergence survey with the pattern of calls on recorded during the emergence survey indicating the building is used for night roosting by a single Greater Horseshoe. Previous survey work found occasional day roosting.

Estimated population in any given year: a single Greater Horseshoe

Brown Long-eared bats

Previous survey work found occasional night roosting by Brown Long-eared bats.

Estimated population in any given year: At least 1 Brown Long-eared bats

5. CONCLUSIONS AND RECOMMENDATIONS

5.1 Proposal

The proposal is to seek planning permission to demolish the existing building and build a new dwelling in its place.

5.2 Potential impacts

The results of the further survey work showed that the interior of the building is used for roosting by a maternity colony of Lesser Horseshoes bats (by at least 19 individuals), by at least a single day roosting Common Pipistrelle and occasional night roosting by a single Greater Horseshoes bat. Previous survey work also showed the presence of an occasional day roost for Greater Horseshoes and a night roost for Brown long-eared bats

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The proposal, in the absence of mitigation would result in destruction of all the existing roosting sites and in the disturbance or harm of any bats present when the building is demolished. With appropriate mitigation, it should be possible to recreate the existing roosting sites onsite, protecting the conservation status of bats in the local area.

As the works will result in the existing roosting sites being destroyed, with any bats present being disturbed or harmed when the building is demolished, a Bat Mitigation Licence from Natural England will need to be obtained, prior to the works commencing. Due to the presence of a maternity colony, a full Bat Mitigation Licence will need to be obtained. The licence application can only be submitted once planning has been granted and the works cannot commence lawfully until the licence is in place.

Bat survey work to support planning applications and Bat Mitigation Licences needs to have been completed within 12 months of the applications being made. If the survey work is older than this it is likely that this would need to be updated.

5.3 Mitigation

As all the existing roosting sites will be destroyed when the building is demolished, replacement roosting sites will need to be created. This will need to include replacement cavity roosting sites for Common Pipistrelles and either a built-in bat loft or standalone bat house suitable for use by a Lesser Horseshoe maternity colony, see below for full details. The bat house or bat loft will need to be created ahead of the demolition of the barn and ideally be completed ahead of this and coexist alongside the exiting roost for a period of time. However,

the Lesser Horseshoes must not be left without a roosting site. A separate dedicated space for use by Greater Horseshoes will also need to be provided.

Immediately before any works commence on site, the building will need to be carefully inspected for the presence of roosting bats by the Ecologist named on the Licence or an accredited agent. When the roof coverings are stripped and any other features with the potential to be used by roosting bats are impacted, this will need to be done carefully under the direct supervision of the named ecologist to ensure no bats are harmed and allow any bats found to be relocated out of harm's way.

As the building is used by breeding bats but is unlikely to be used by hibernating bats the works should avoid commencing during the summer period (May to September).

5.3.1 Exclusions and on-site supervision

Immediately before any works commence on site, the building will need to be carefully inspected externally, for the presence of roosting bats by the Ecologist named on the Licence or an accredited agent. Any individuals of the cavity roosting species of bat found will be carefully caught and moved out of harm's way into the bat box erected onsite.

When the roof coverings and eaves capping on the building are stripped, and any other features with the potential to be used by roosting bats are removed, this will need to be done carefully under the direct supervision of the named ecologist to ensure no bats are harmed and allow any bats found to be relocated out of harm's way.

A short briefing will be given to the contractor undertaking the works at the start of the works to each building on the status of the building with regards to bats, the mitigation measures to be followed and implemented, and what to do if a bat were to be found unexpectedly during the works.

5.3.2 Provision of temporary roosting sites

Suitable alternative roosting provisions will need to be provided ahead of the works commencing and be available throughout the works. For Lesser Horseshoes this will involve the creation of the permanent replacement roosting site and for Common Pipistrelles either the erection of a suitable bat box or built in cavity roost into the Lesser Horseshoe permanent replacement roosting site. A separate space, segregated from the Lesser Horseshoes will need to be created for the Greater Horseshoe bats.

5.3.3 Retaining or recreated existing roosting sites

As all the existing roosting sites will be destroyed when the building is demolished, replacement roosting sites will need to be created.

For Lesser Horseshoes either a standalone bat house or bat loft built into a building which can be built ahead of the demolition of the barn (e.g. a bat loft built into the roof space of a garage) will need to be created.

If a bat house is proposed this will need to be built from stone or blockwork and measure approximately 6 metres deep, by 4 metres wide and 4.5 metre high. It will have a pitched roof with gable ends and internally it will have an enclosed roof space at its western end 2.25 metres deep by 3 metres wide and 2 metres high with an opening 400mm² in the centre. It will be accessed via a fly-in access point, measuring 300mm high by 600mm wide, set into the door at one end of the building with a small, enclosed porch behind with a fly-in access point into the main chamber offset from the one to outside to reduce light spill. The underside of the roof, which will be covered with natural slate or concrete tiles, must be lined with bitumen based type 1 roofing felt.

If a bat loft is to be built into the roof space of another building onsite this should measure approximately 6 metres deep, by 4 metres wide and 2.5 metre high with a ground floor room approximately 2.5 metres square. It will be accessed via a fly-in access point, measuring 300mm high by 600mm wide, set into a gable end with an internal baffle. The underside of the roof, which will be covered with natural slate or concrete tiles, must be lined with bitumen based type 1 roofing felt.

Either option will be built on an east west alignment with a south facing slope to the roof for solar gain, close to the western boundary.

A separate space for use by Greater Horseshoes will need to be created for the occasional day roosting Greater Horseshoe. This must be segregated from the Lesser Horseshoe bats.

In addition, care will need to be taken to ensure light spill out from the interior of the new building, or from lighting mounted onto its exterior, in the vicinity of the access point and into the surrounding habitats and adjacent lane is kept to an absolute minimum, with 0.1 lux being the absolute maximum.

For Common Pipistrelles a replacement cavity roosting site, either built into the building containing the bat loft or standalone bat house, will need to be provided by building in a built in bat box into the western gable end.

5.3.4 Timing

As the building is used by breeding bats but is unlikely to be used by hibernating bats the works should avoid commencing during the summer maternity period (May to September).

6. CONCLUSIONS AND RECOMMENDATIONS

The results of the further survey work showed that the interior of the building used for roosting by a maternity colony of Lesser Horseshoes bats (by at least 19 individuals), by at least a single day roosting Common Pipistrelle and occasional night roosting by a single Greater Horseshoes bat. Previous survey work found an occasional day roost by Greater Horseshoes and a night roost by Brown Long-eared bats. The proposal is to seek planning permission to demolish the existing building and build a new dwelling in its place.

The proposal, in the absence of mitigation would result in destruction of all the existing roosting sites and in the disturbance or harm of any bats present when the building is demolished. With appropriate mitigation, it should be possible to recreate the existing roosting sites onsite, protecting the conservation status of bats in the local area.

As the works will result in the existing roosting sites being destroyed, with any bats present being disturbed or harmed when the building is demolished, a Bat Mitigation Licence from Natural England will need to be obtained, prior to the works commencing. Due to the presence of a maternity colony, a full Bat Mitigation Licence will need to be obtained. The licence application can only be submitted once planning has been granted and the works cannot commence lawfully until the licence is in place.

As all the existing roosting sites will be destroyed when the building is demolished, replacement roosting sites will need to be created. This will need to include replacement cavity roosting sites for Common Pipistrelles and either a built-in bat loft or standalone bat house suitable for use by a Lesser Horseshoe maternity colony, see below for full details. The bat house or bat loft will need to be created ahead of the demolition of the barn and ideally be completed ahead of this and coexist alongside the exiting roost for a period of time. However, the Lesser Horseshoes must not be left without a roosting site. A separate dedicated space for Greater Horseshoes will need to be provided.

Immediately before any works commence on site, the building will need to be carefully inspected for the presence of roosting bats by the Ecologist named on the Licence or an accredited agent. When the roof coverings are stripped and any other features with the potential to be used by roosting bats are impacted, this will need to be done carefully under the direct supervision of the named ecologist to ensure no bats are harmed and allow any bats found to be relocated out of harm's way.

As the building is used by breeding bats but is unlikely to be used by hibernating bats the works should avoid commencing during the summer Maternity period (May to September).

7. LEGISLATION

Bats in England have been protected under a number of regulations and amendments but the most up-to-date and relevant are:

The Conservation of Habitats and Species Regulations 2017
Wildlife and Countryside Act 1981 (Section 9)

The result of Regulations and Acts is that all species of bat and their breeding sites or resting places (roosts) are protected under law. It is an offence to:

Deliberately capture, injure or kill a bat
Deliberately disturb a bat in a way that would affect its ability to survive, breed or rear young or significantly affect the local distribution or abundance of the species
Intentionally or recklessly disturb a bat at a roost
Intentionally or recklessly obstruct access to a roost whether bats are present or not
Damage or destroy a roost whether bats are present or not
Possess, control, transport, sell, exchange or offer for sale/exchange any live or dead bat or any part of a bat

Through the Conservation (Natural Habitats &c.) Regulations 1994 (this has been updated and consolidated with subsequent amendments by the Conservation of Habitats and Species Regulations 2017 mentioned above) bats were designated a European protected species as part of Europe wide effort to conserve certain plant and animal species.

Any development which is likely to result in the disturbance of a European protected species, or damage to its habitat usually requires a European protected species licence from Natural England. 'Development' is interpreted broadly to include projects involving demolition of buildings, rebuilding, structural alterations and additions to buildings.

8. REFERENCES

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APPENDIX 1. Start and finish screenshots from cameras

First survey on 11th May

Images 1 & 2. Western aspect of the building



Images 3 & 4. Eastern aspect of the building



Images 5 & 6. Northern aspect of the building



Images 7 & 8. Southern aspect of the building



Second survey on 10th June 2026

Images 9 & 10. Western aspect of the building



Images 11 & 12. Eastern aspect of the building



Images 13 & 14. Northern aspect of the building



Images 15 & 16. Western and Southern aspects of the building

